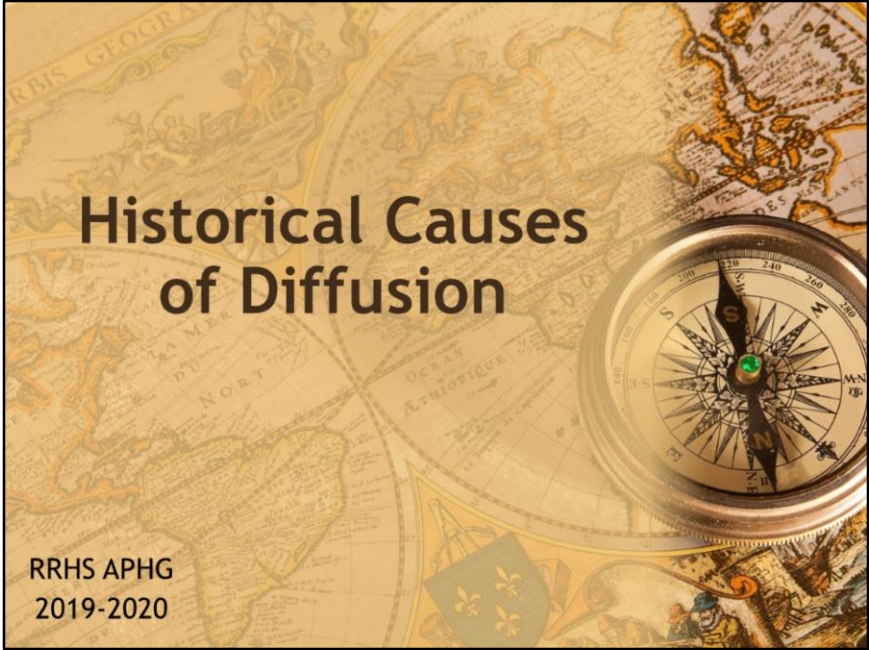


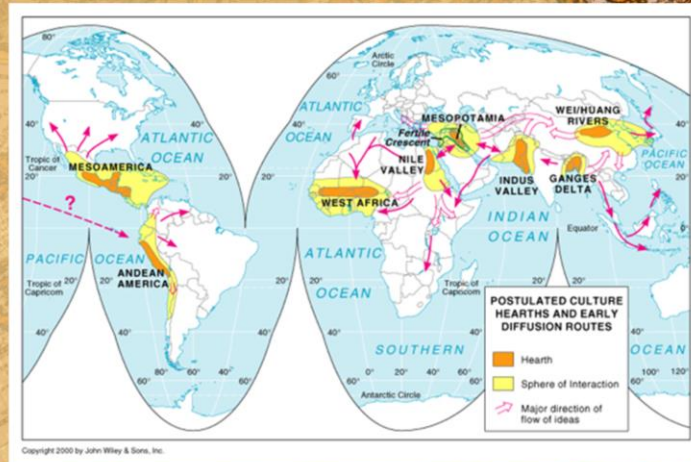
The background of the slide features a historical map with a compass rose. The map is aged and yellowed, with various geographical labels in Latin and French, including 'ORBIS GEOGRAPHICUS', 'OCEANUS ATLANTICUS', and 'AFRICA'. A brass compass rose is positioned in the lower right quadrant, showing cardinal and intercardinal directions. The title 'Historical Causes of Diffusion' is centered over the map.

Historical Causes of Diffusion

RRHS APHG
2019-2020

Cultural Hearths

- Place of origin



A **cultural hearth** is an area where cultural traits develop and from which cultural traits diffuse (spread).

The map above shows the world's major cultural hearths – these are places where cultural traits, such as language and religion originated and diffuse. Yes, you need to know these by name and where they are in the world. This knowledge will be important later, so learn them now.

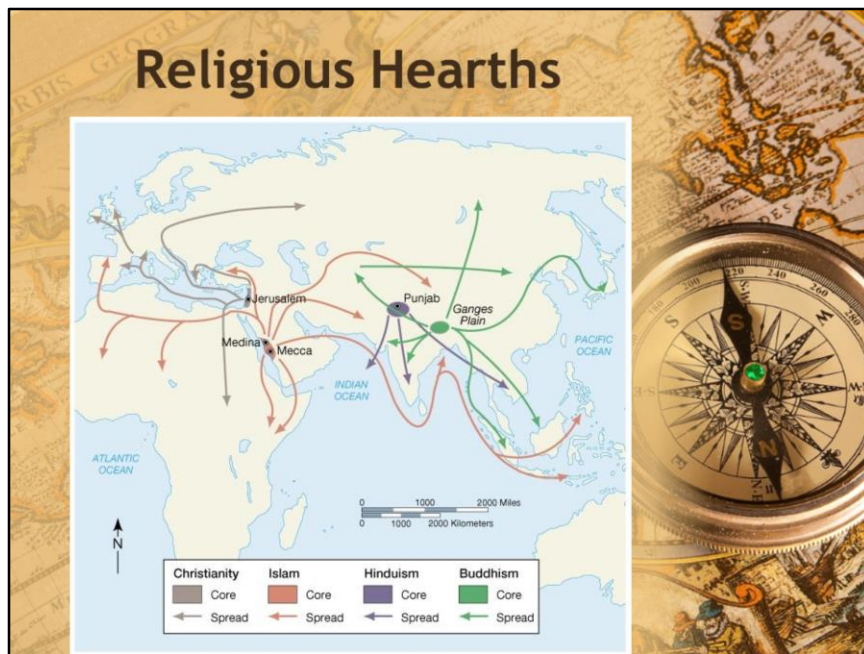
What develops and diffuses from a cultural hearth?

All traits of culture start somewhere – the major cultural systems of the world, however, began in these hearths. Cultural traits/complexes/systems that developed include innovations such as agriculture (how to grow food on purpose), inventions (tools and boats), as well as traits such as language and religions. Institutions also developed in these ancient hearths, such as marriage and systems of education.

Culture is learned. We are not born with any sets of knowledge, speaking any language, or following any particular belief system. Instead, we learn our culture from those around us, through our families and the institutions that pass culture on from one generation to the next. Culture changes over time and space as we interact with

others or are separated by distance decay.

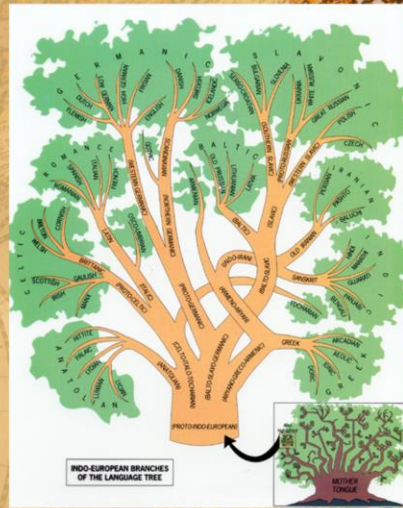
Think back to Unit 2 and note that these earliest cultural hearths are also home to *most* of the world's largest population clusters.



We'll look more at these hearths when we discuss the diffusion of religion. Note the similarity between the ancient culture hearths and the hearths of the religions – very similar! Also keep in mind that religion and language are two of the main traits of cultural and ethnic identity.

Language Hearths

- Difficult to trace to a specific place of origin
 - Spoken language dates back to very first humans
 - Written language developed in earliest civilizations



Languages are more difficult to trace back to a single point of origin because the origins of language date back to well before humans were settled. These pre-historic* spoken languages were much different than how we know language today, however. These languages were tribal – each small family group had their own verbalizations to communicate. After humans became sedentary farmers, however, language became much more complex. Rules for the languages were created and spellings and pronunciations standardized. Writing became a physical symbol of that language. As such, languages can be traced backward from where we are today to what are known as “language families”, which can be traced to the earliest civilization hearths – however, each language family is just one small branch on the greater history tree of language. We’ll look more at how the diffusion of language is studied later this unit.

*note: pre-historic means “before written records”

For a bigger/clearer example of the image above, please see page 155 in your book. Read the caption.

Innovation

- Create new method, idea, or product
- Innovation hearth
 - Place where new innovation began
- Independent innovation
 - A trait can be traced back to multiple hearths where it developed *independent (without contact)* of other places




Innovations – new methods, ideas, or products – develop in a hearth. From that hearth, they diffuse to other places.

For example, the earliest innovation of the plow (plough), a farming tool used to prepare soil for agriculture (see image above), can be traced back to the ancient Indus Valley Civilization, and then spread from that hearth to nearby places.

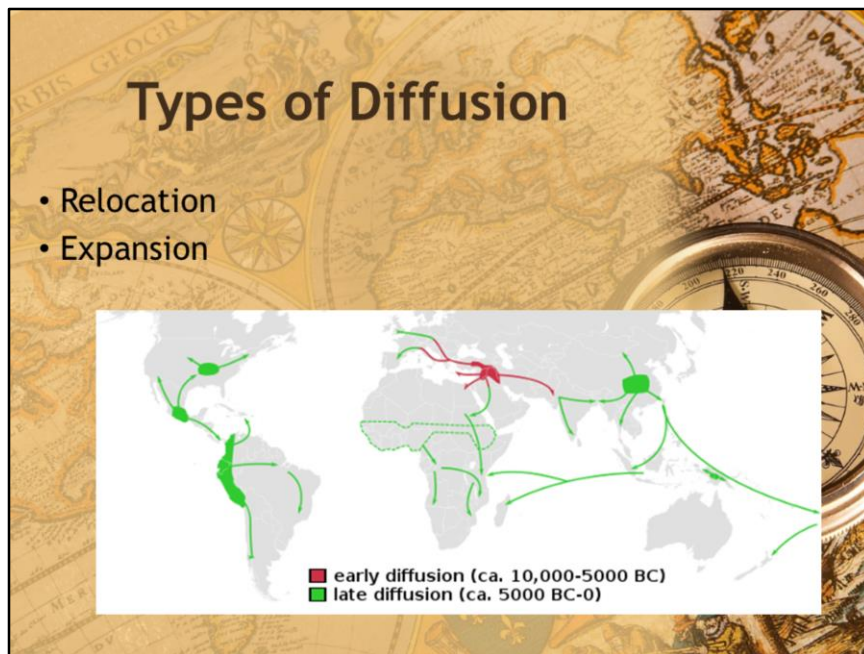
Other civilizations also (independently) developed agriculture and tools to turn the soil in preparation for crops without contact with the ancient Indus Valley civilization, and as a result, they have varying designs/methods unique to their hearths.

Other innovations developed independently in multiple places – writing systems, marriage (method of family structure), religions, farming and irrigation.

Example of independent innovation: The pyramids. Who invented them? The Egyptians and the Mayans both had them, but they took different forms.

Once these innovations were developed, they spread out of their hearths and to

other places. With that later interaction (cultural convergence) came improvements on others' systems and overall growth in the knowledge pool.



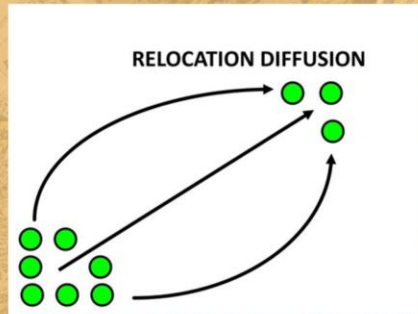
There are two main categories of diffusion: Relocation and Expansion.

With **relocation diffusion**, innovations/culture are diffused because a person physically moves from one place to another, and the number of people practicing the cultural trait (innovation/method/idea/etc.) remains the same.

With **expansion diffusion**, the number of people who have adopted the cultural trait **increases**. Expansion diffusion occurs as the result of cultural convergence – the interaction of people from different cultures who exchange ideas. Globalization and the time-space convergence have sped up the process of expansion diffusion.

Relocation Diffusion

- Result of migration
- Number of people exhibiting cultural trait remains unchanged



Relocation diffusion occurs through the physical relocation of people from one place to another – when people move, they take their culture with them. Therefore, their cultural traits have moved to a new location which changes the spatial distribution of that trait, but the number of people exhibiting that trait (or innovation) remains the same.



Expansion diffusion occurs when the number of people exhibiting a cultural trait (or innovation) *increases* – more people are adopting the trait (or innovation) in new places, and as a result the spatial pattern associated with that trait changes. Expansion diffusion can occur through direct interaction between people (contagious), jump from place to place in a “top down” pattern (hierarchical), or even be adopted but adapted to fit the local culture (stimulus).

Note – no one form of diffusion exists in isolation. It is possible for the same trait to diffuse through relocation and then expand as the migrants begin interacting with new groups of people. To determine the difference, you will need to examine the context of what is being described in the example provided. The following few slides give more details and examples of each type of diffusion.

Contagious Diffusion

- Type of expansion diffusion
- Occurs due to direct contact/sharing from person to person

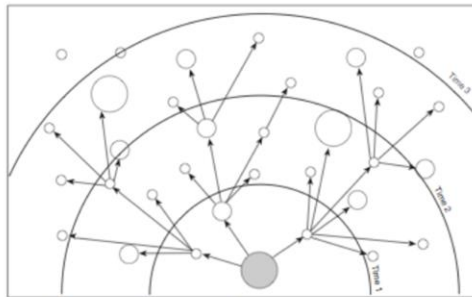
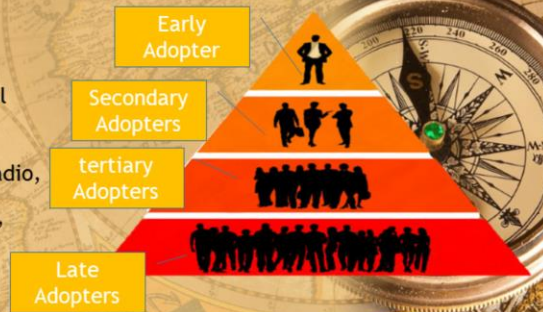


Figure 3.3a Typical contagious diffusion spreading like a wave.

Contagious diffusion spreads person-to-person in *waves* away from the source.

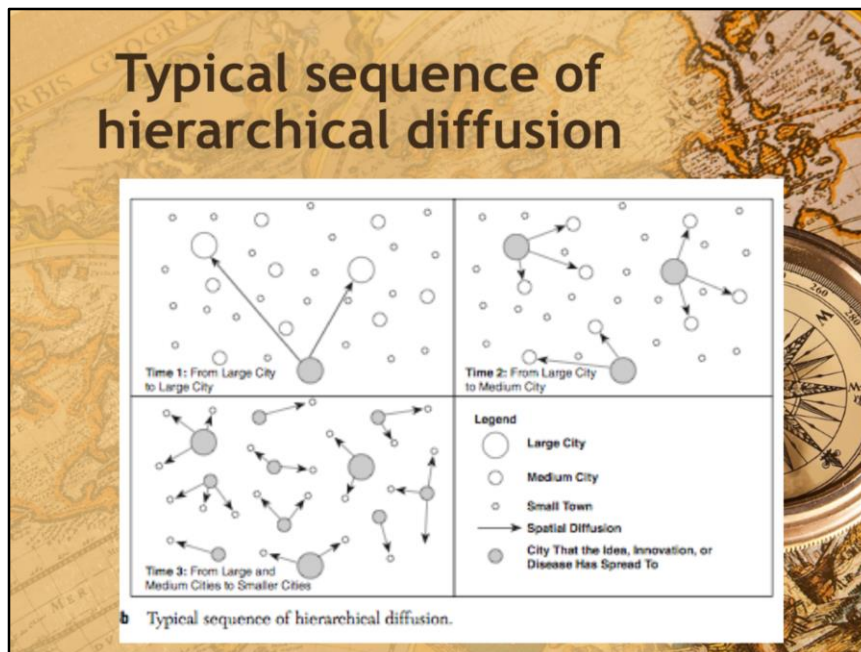
Hierarchical Diffusion

- Type of expansion diffusion
- Spread of cultural trait begins with person or place of power
 - Large cities
 - King/queen or political leader
 - Celebrities
 - Media sources (i.e., radio, television, movie production companies, etc.)
- “Top down” spread of innovations



Hierarchical Diffusion occurs from the “top” down – a person of influence, power, or higher social status is among the first to adopt a new cultural trait (early adopter). That person then passes it to people under their influence, who in turn pass it to people under their influence, and then finally it makes its way to the masses.

For example – lets say Mr. Groff goes to a workshop and learns about a new educational practice. He likes it, so he decides we at Round Rock High School will adopt this new practice. He brings it back and teaches the new educational technique to the other admin (assistant principals) here on campus. The assistant principals pass the information along to the team leads (the teacher in each subject who takes charge of planning), the team leads bring it back to all the teachers of that subject. Finally, all the teachers in the school are using that practice in their classrooms (often because they were told to do so by someone in a higher position of power within the school).



The typical sequence of hierarchical diffusion is that an innovation first spread:

First, innovations spread from large city to large city (due in part to the gravity model – based on Newton's universal law of gravitation, which measures the attraction of two objects based off their mass (population and degree of centrality) and distance – the bigger the mass, the greater the attraction (volume of flow of people and ideas)).

Next, the innovation will spread from each of the large cities to nearby medium-sized cities.

Finally, the innovation will spread from the large and medium-sized cities to smaller cities, eventually reaching rural areas.

Clothing styles are a good example of a cultural trait that spread hierarchically. It is developed in the fashion hearths of the world – Paris, Milan, and others – and diffuses to other large cities such as New York, Los Angeles, Tokyo, etc. where the fashion designers have their flagship (main) stores (i.e., Vera Wang, Chanel, and others). From there it makes its ways to stores in medium sized cities such as Austin, Denver, Oklahoma City, etc. and the large luxury department stores (such as Neiman

Marcus, Dillards) Finally, (often a year or so later), the new styles are introduced into smaller cities and towns via discount retail chains such as Target and Walmart.

Celebrities and other people of power (such as political leaders) are often the “early adopters” of new innovations or products. For example, Under Armor began as an athletic gear supplier for professional football players. Then, the brand was adopted by college foot teams. Later, because of the influence of the college teams, high school football coaches start using Under Armor athletic gear for their teams. Eventually, it becomes the standard recognized brand among youth athletics as well.

Stimulus Diffusion

- Type of expansion diffusion
- *Idea* is adopted in a new location
- *Changed* to reflect local culture

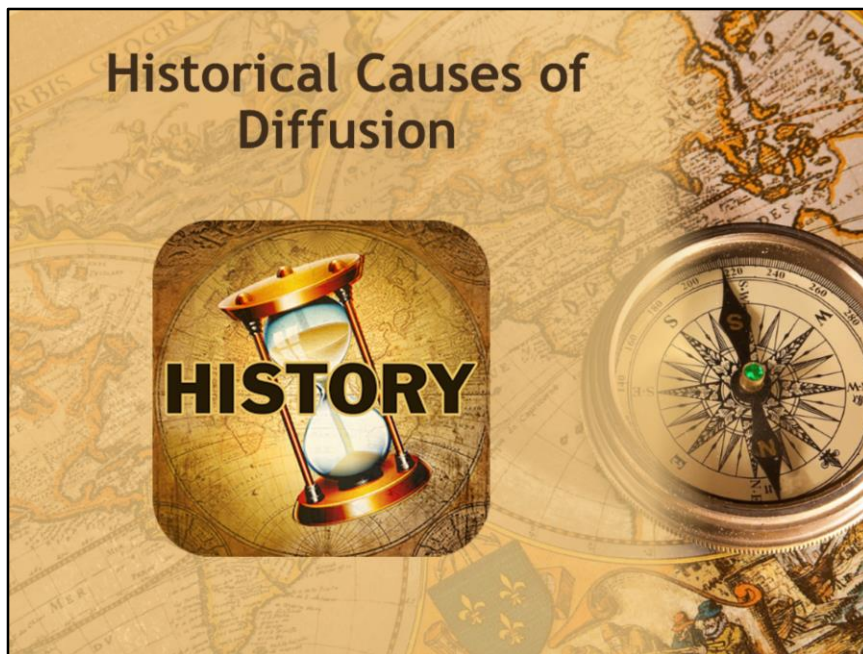


Stimulus diffusion happens when an *idea* spreads to a new place, and then the products associated with that idea are changed to fit the local culture.

The global diffusion of Barbie and McDonalds are two examples of stimulus diffusion.

With McDonalds, the *idea* that diffused was the fast-food model and brand. However, the menu looks very different in other countries as the foods served have been changed to fit the food preferences of the local cultures of other countries.

The “Fulla” doll developed in Syria and sold in Islamic countries is very similar to the Barbie doll – the concept of the doll that reflects different women in society with changeable clothes – has been adapted to the culture, clothing, and physical appearance of women and girls in the countries where the doll is sold (such as Egypt, Jordan, Qatar, Syria, etc.).



In this class, we will often talk about geographic issues in two phases – “historical” and “contemporary”.

Historical refers to everything before modern technology – typically prior to World War II (1940s) going all the way back to ancient history. In the period before modern technology, people or an object had to physically move around the world for interaction to occur – whether the person themselves or letters.

Contemporary refers to the period since the end of World War II – typically the past 50 years or so. In the contemporary era, people (or objects) no longer have to physically move in order to interact with other people in other parts of the world. Additionally, when movement occurs, it is much faster and more accessible in the contemporary period than it was in the historical period – barriers to diffusion such as distance and oceans have been removed (time-space compression). Additionally, the period of European political and economic dominance over other parts of the world (colonialism and imperialism) came to a close following World War II.

This set of notes will provide examples of historical diffusions that created many of the cultural patterns we see today.

Colonization

- The Americas
 - settlers
 - The Columbian Exchange



European colonization of the Americas resulted in the spread of European culture was first the result of relocation diffusion – the colonists/settlers physically relocated to the new continent.

Colonization is the action of appropriating (taking) a place or domain for one's own use, spreading culture and creating an extension of the home country. It occurs when one nation subjugates another, conquering its population and exploiting it, often while forcing its own language and cultural values upon its people.

European colonialism, also known as the Age of Discovery, began with Portugal and Spain competing for trade routes and trading posts outside of Europe. Christopher Columbus “discovered” the Bahamas while attempting to sail westward around the world to reach India and China (this is why the Caribbean is sometimes referred to as the “West Indies”). Eventually, seeing the prosperity of the Spanish and Portuguese empires (collection of colonies), other European nations sent out explorers and colonist of their own. Over time, the English built the world’s largest network of colonies – at one point having a colony in every time zone so that the “Sun never set on the British Empire”

European colonization of the Americas – with Spain and Portugal claiming the bulk of

Central and South America and the English and French claiming the majority of North America, spread people and culture to the Western Hemisphere (relocation diffusion). They conquered and subjugated the natives and forced them to learn their cultures (hierarchical diffusion). The invasion of the Europeans had devastating effects on the native populations as some estimates say that up to 90% of them died due to contracting Europeans diseases for which they had no immunity, war, and captivity. As a result, the native cultures of the Americas have virtually disappeared (except for small pockets) and the European cultures of the colonists became the common culture of these regions.

The colonists, in their economic pursuits also forced the migration of large populations of Africans to the Americas with the Atlantic slave trade.



Besides moving European cultures to the Americas (and other places around the world), European colonialism had another impact: the Columbian Exchange.

The **Columbian exchange**, named for Christopher Columbus (given credit (though possibly erroneously) for the “discovery” of the Americana continent in the late 15th century (1400s)), was the widespread transfer of plants, animals, culture, human populations, technology, diseases, and ideas between the Americas, West Africa, and the Old World in the 15th and 16th centuries.

The Columbian exchange marked the first time that the world (and cultural exchange) was truly “Global” – before it was blocked by oceans, but technology (boats and the ability of sailors to measure longitude for navigation purposes across the ocean) made world travel and cultural exchange a possibility. It was revolutionary (change in way of life) as plants and animals from the new world provided a new variety of nutrient-rich foods that contributed to the rapid population growth in Europe during that time period. Overcrowding in Europe led many people to risk crossing the ocean in hopes of finding land to farm - and to be able to support their families with the food they grew.

Imperialism

- South Asia
- Southeast Asia
- Africa



Imperialism is a policy or ideology of extending a nation's rule over foreign nations, often by military force or by gaining political and economic control of other areas that already had an existing political, economic, and social structure (nations). It usually involved a combination of both – taking force with military and establishing political and economic control over another settled place. The goal is not the wide-spread expansion of culture, but rather profit and power. Such was the case of European expansion into South Asia (India) and Africa. The “colonies” in these locations were often originally set up as economic endeavors.

Imperialism

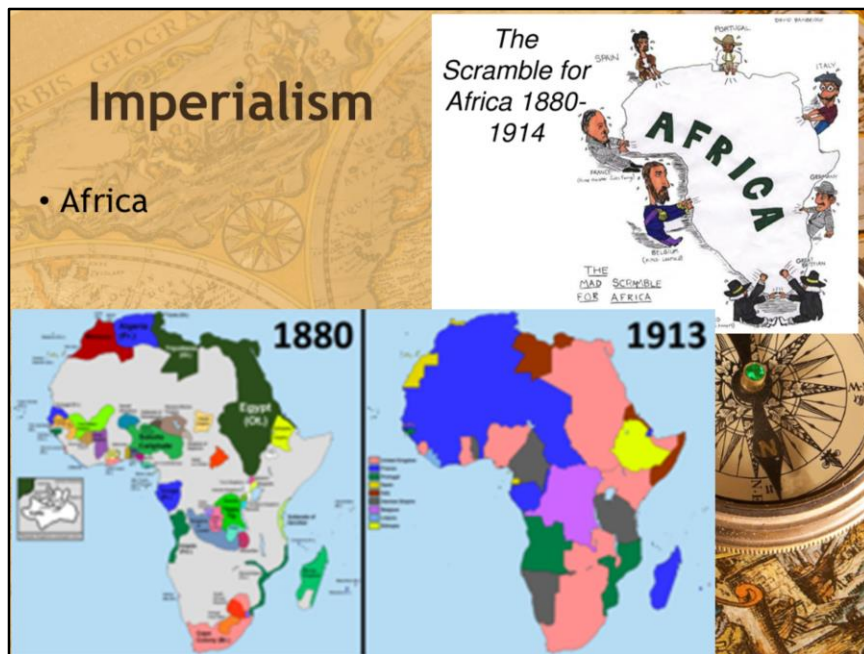
- South and Southeast Asia



Imperialism tended to begin with economic aspirations. In order to meet these goals, the imperializing country would take over the government and economy of an existing country/nation.

For example, the **East India Company (EIC)** was formed to trade in the Indian Ocean region, initially with Mughal India and the East Indies, and later with Qing China. The company ended up seizing control over large parts of the Indian subcontinent, colonized parts of Southeast Asia, and colonized Hong Kong after a war with Qing China. The company expanded from economic to territorial control in order to maintain its trade dominance against rivals of the French (which controlled Vietnam, Laos, Cambodia and other countries in southeast Asia) and the Dutch (which controlled much of Indonesia).

Cultural exchange occurred due to Imperialism, but not to the same extent as in colonization – natives learned the language of their colonial powers (even though it was imperialism, the other countries are still referred to as colonial powers), but did not fully adopt the cultures of the outsiders – religions remained the same, native languages were still used within families and communities, etc.

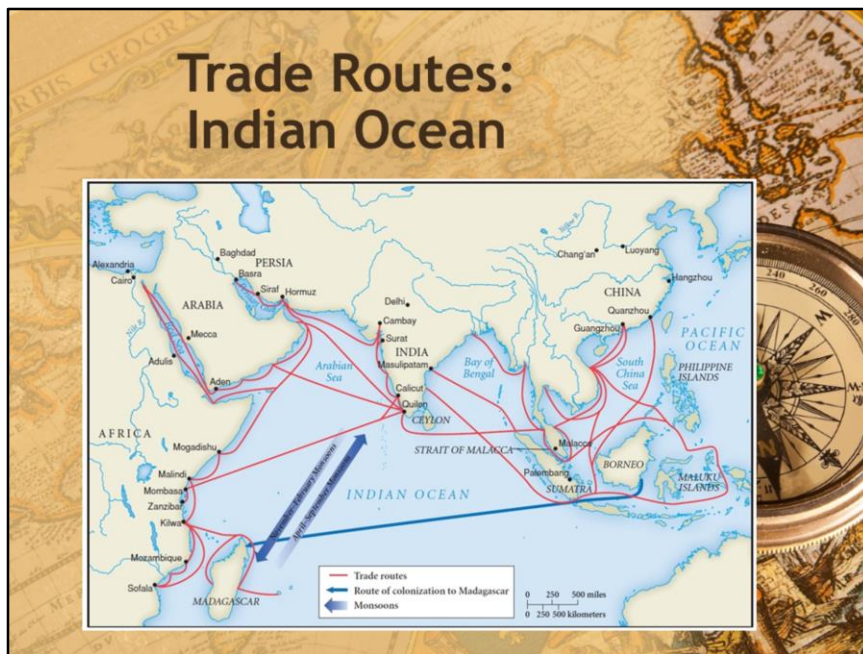


The “Scramble for Africa” was a process of invasion, occupation, colonization and annexation of **African** territory by European powers during the New Imperialism period, between 1881 and World War I in 1914. Leaders from European countries met and drew new boundaries over the continent of Africa, dividing up the territories for their own claims. These new boundaries paid no attention at all to the existing cultural/tribal patterns already in existence, and set up the continent for cultural conflict in the future after the end of European imperialism following World War II.



- Connected people from different places
- Led to cultural diffusion

The only way to get products and resources you *Want* that your geographic territory does not have is to *TRADE* for it (or take over the territory that has it...but that's imperialism, not trade).



The Indian Ocean trade routes were a network of ports and shipping channels around the Indian Ocean that were the dominant trade routes in the region for over 700 years. This route was an alternative to the Silk Road, which moved over land and lessened the relative importance of cities along that route.

Monsoons (seasonal shift in the wind) made these trade routes reliable – wind was what powered the ships, and since the sailors knew when the wind was going to be blowing in each direction, they could plan their routes around it.

Chokepoints were very important along the Indian Ocean trade routes, because the nation that controlled those narrow ocean lanes were able to stop any ships from crossing – or charge them a hefty tax to pass through. These nations became very wealthy and powerful, but were also vulnerable to invasion from other nations who wanted to control the chokepoints.

The chokepoints had another impact: the European nations began looking for an alternative route to access the resources available from East, Southeast, and South Asia, they wanted to avoid the middlemen (merchants) who were reaping the profits of the trade routes. Once Europe rose to global economic and political dominance,

the power of the Indian Ocean traders was greatly diminished.

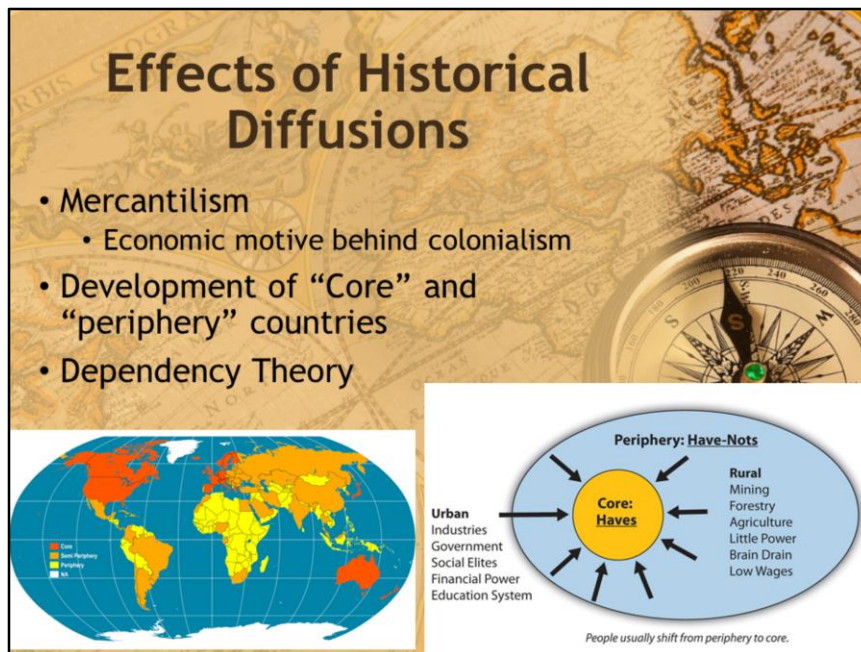
Muslim Merchants The middlemen were predominantly Muslim merchants – this means they interacted with many people in each of the port cities around the Indian Ocean. This led to the diffusion (contagious) of their culture to people in these places. Today, the predominant religion in many of these historic port cities. Today, Indonesia (in southwest Asia) is the most populous Muslim country in the world due to the Indian Ocean traders sharing their beliefs as they traded.



The Triangle Trade refers to a profitable network of trade between the Americas, Europe, and Western Africa across the Atlantic Ocean

The Americas provided raw materials which were sold to Europe to make manufactured goods (the Industrial Revolution began in Europe), which were then sold back to the American colonists and to West African merchants in exchange for slaves. The slaves were forcibly sold to land owners in the Americas and used to produce more raw materials (cotton, tobacco, rubber, etc.) to be sold back to Europe.

Most of the countries of the American colonies gained independence through war by the mid 19th century (1800s), beginning with the United States in 1776.



Mercantilism is the economic theory that trade generates wealth and is stimulated by the accumulation of profitable balances, which a government should encourage by means of protectionism. **Protectionism** is the practice of taxing imports in order to protect domestic (in-house) production of goods.

In the Age of Discovery and into the age of the colonialism and imperialism), Europeans took control over foreign territories in order to gain access to their raw materials for their own manufacturing purposes. Their economic and political dominance over these other places also allowed them to form a monopoly of trade with their colonies – the colonies were **ONLY** allowed to import manufactured products from their occupiers, and then they had to pay taxes on it to boot (P.S., this is one of the major issues that riled up the American colonists and led to them declaring independence from England – more on that in our Political unit). They were also **ONLY** allowed to sell their raw materials back to their colonizers.

These trade monopolies set up a global pattern of poor vs. wealthy, of raw material suppliers vs. manufacturers. This pattern can still be seen in the world today and is explained by the Dependency Theory – where the “Core” countries (the mother countries and industrialized nations) dominated the “periphery” countries (the

colonies and raw material suppliers). Raw material production is a primary economic activity – and as you know based on the DTM, countries with a high percentage of the population engaged in primary economic activities (farming, mining, etc.) have lower levels of social and economic development.

Dependency Theory maintains that the core countries are dependent on the periphery countries for the raw materials, and by necessity the Core countries kept the periphery countries dependent on them as a market for their raw materials.

Effects of Historical Diffusions

- Creolization



Creolization is the blending of distinctive cultures, particularly those based around plantation agriculture and slavery – for example, in Haiti, the creolized culture includes influences from indigenous American tribes, the French (who colonized Haiti), and the African slaves who occupied the land. The Creole culture is expressed in music, art, language, and religion. This process occurred in Caribbean countries, which were then dependent on their colonizers (mostly British, some French) for protection (military) and economically.

Creole cultures are especially dominant in maroon communities. **Maroon communities** were created by fugitive (escaped) slaves who had succeeded in establishing a society of their own in some remote areas, where they could not easily be surprised by soldiers or slave catchers.

The map above illustrates the diffusion of creole religions (such as Vodoun and Hoodoo) from the Caribbean into areas in the North and South America.



At one point, France dominated global trade – as such, French was the language of choice for merchants and traders who spoke different languages. The term ***lingua franca*** came to mean a 3rd language used by two people who speak different languages in order to communicate (especially to conduct business). *Lingua Franca* translates as “French tongue”.

Any language can be a *lingua franca* – what makes it one is that the language used is not the first (or native) language of either speaker – it is a 3rd language that both can use to facilitate communication.

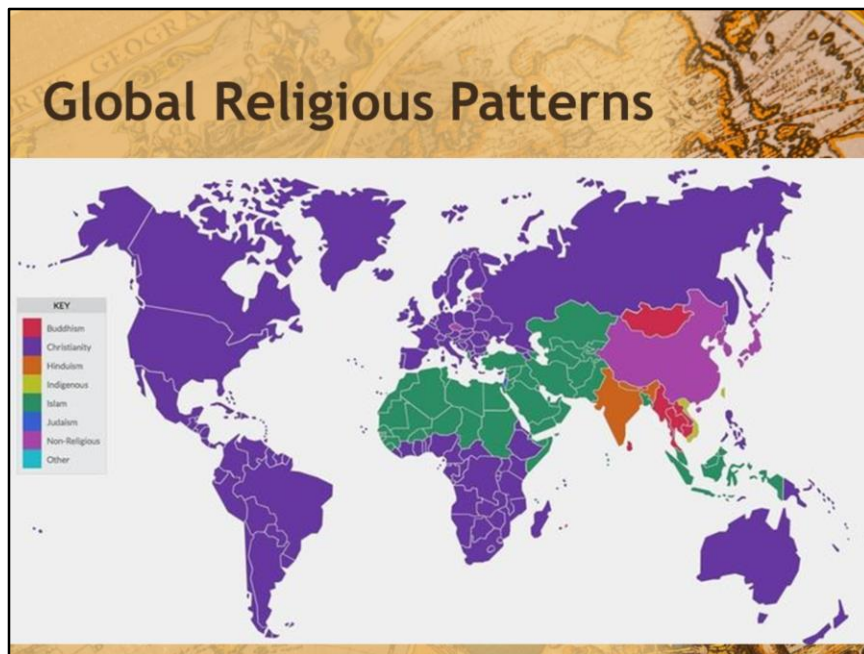
Common examples of *lingua francas*:

English became a world-wide lingua franca during the days of the British Empire – English colonies often adopted English as an official language of government and business since those controlling the government and the economy were English. This was a historical reason that the English language diffused around the world (remember, the “Sun never sets on the British Empire”)

Swahili is a common *lingua franca* in Eastern Africa – it is a language of trade and many countries have included it as an official language of government and trade,

which is especially important in a region where many different tribal languages are spoken.

Esperanto is a constructed language that was created in the late 19th Century (1800s) as an easy-to-learn flexible language based on Latin that the creator hoped would foster peace and international understanding. About 2 million people speak Esperanto as a 2nd language today, mostly as a hobby. Critics of the constructed language argue that it was just another European language, and as a result, it failed to gain a foothold as a universal *lingua franca*.



Global religious patterns have their roots in Colonization and trade.

On the map above, the **purple areas** are predominantly **Christian** – the Christian religion spread through relocation (settlers), hierarchical (to the natives and slaves), and contagious (via missionaries, especially in Sub-Saharan Africa) diffusion from its Hearth in Southwest Asia (modern day Israel). At the time of Christianity's founding, the hearth was under the control of the Roman Empire. When the Emperor Constantine adopted the religion in the 4th Century (300s), he ordered all his subjects to convert as well (hierarchical diffusion). The Romans spread the religion into Europe, and the European countries spread it to their colonies.

The **green areas** are predominantly **Islamic**, which, as discussed earlier, spread via the traders and merchants along the Indian Ocean trade routes (contagious diffusion). Islam in North Africa spread as rulers converted to the religion and therefore so did the citizens (hierarchical).

South Asia is predominantly Hindu. This pattern exists because the European countries that colonized these regions primarily had imperialistic intentions (economic control) rather than trying to expand their culture to the new lands. As a

result, the natives of these lands were not made to convert to Christianity, so the religion did not spread as readily there as it did to the other colonies to which large numbers of settlers from the mother country relocated. There are large numbers of Muslims (a follower of Islam) within India, however, but they make up a minority of the population since the Great Partition of India and Pakistan (remember that from your Effects of Migration notes?).

Southeast Asia is predominantly Buddhist as it did not have much outside influence from either the Europeans or the Muslim traders (not easily accessible as ports at the time). Buddhism spread into the region contagiously from nearly India (its hearth).

China is shown as “non-religious” – this is a result of it being under communist control for the better part of a century (communist governments often discourage or ban religion).